

Pembina-Emerson Port of Entry Transportation Study

Background

Situated along the Red River between the towns of Emerson, Manitoba, and Pembina, North Dakota, the Pembina-Emerson Port of Entry (POE) experienced frequent flooding from the river and its tributaries. The flooding caused closures at the POE, forcing traffic to take significant detours.

Manitoba Infrastructure and Transportation (MIT), together with the North Dakota Department of Transportation (NDDOT), the U.S. General Services Administration (GSA), and Transport Canada (TC), initiated a transportation study to provide a conceptual master plan to guide the development of the POE, its operations, and adjacent land uses for the next 20 years.

Scope

Gannett Fleming prepared the transportation study to improve safety, facilities, and operations at the POE, while maximizing efficiency and reliability. The study would also facilitate the creation of a cross-border planning committee to assume lasting responsibility for the stewardship of the POE transportation corridor development plan.

Our firm performed a background study of the POE and its surrounding areas. We executed an environmental scan and a comprehensive traffic analysis that focused on regulatory context, trade, traffic volume, safety, security, and the use of innovative technologies at the POE.

An analysis of the opportunities and constraints of the POE, largely focusing on flooding and land use concerns, was conducted and combined with the findings of the background study. Using these results in conjunction with the traffic analysis findings, we generated a plan to accommodate the traffic, POE operations, and surrounding land uses for the next 20 years, while balancing stakeholder issues and concerns.



The Pembina-Emerson POE frequently closed due to flooding, forcing traffic to detour.

Client

Manitoba Infrastructure and Transportation

Location

Pembina, North Dakota, and
Emerson, Manitoba, Canada

Fee

\$200,000

Accomplishments

Using comments and feedback from MIT; TC; NDDOT; GSA; and other stakeholders, a final recommended POE alternative was developed, which included a phasing plan, and the total cost of improvements, broken down by agency. The final report described the planning process and the conceptual plan for the POE, complete with comprehensive drawings and an analysis of the issues and solutions.